

अपूर्व चन्द्रा, भा.प्र.से.

सचिव

APURVA CHANDRA, IAS
Secretary



सत्यमेव जयते



D.O.No.M-25013/2/2024-MUC-I

भारत सरकार

सूचना एवं प्रसारण मंत्रालय

शास्त्री भवन, नई दिल्ली - 110001

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

MINISTRY OF INFORMATION & BROADCASTING

SHASTRI BHAWAN, NEW DELHI - 110001

9th January 2024

Dear Chief Secretary

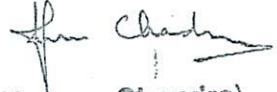
I would like to inform that the "Press and Registration of Periodicals Act 2023" has been enacted and notified on 29.12.2023. The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting has also prepared the Draft Press and Registration of Periodicals (PRP) Rules, 2024 under the Act. Both these documents are available on the Ministry's website www.mib.gov.in (what's new). Further, the Press and Registration of Books Act 1867 shall stand repealed from the date the Press and Registration of Periodicals (PRP) Act 2023 comes into effect. The PRP Act is significant from three stand points; firstly it does away with the colonial era statute of more than 150 years back; secondly it substantially decriminalizes the various provisions which were there in the Act of 1867; thirdly, from the perspective of Ease of Doing Business, it seeks to set up an online mechanism for title allotment and grant of registration to periodicals in a manner which is simple, smart and simultaneous.

2. The PRP Act substantially changes the role of the State Governments/and the "Specified Authorities (District Magistrates, District Collectors, etc) vis-à-vis their roles under the PRB Act 1867. A brief on the new roles and responsibilities of the State Government/and the Specified Authorities is annexed. I would request that the concerned officers in the State Government and the District Authorities are made aware of the new legislation and their roles and responsibilities. Further, advance preparations may be made for issuing notification by the State Government specifying the "specified authorities" and nominating of an office to receive free of cost the newspapers from the publisher, may be made at the earliest. Since the legislation has far reaching effect, you may also like to nominate a senior officer in the State Government to coordinate these matters. The name and other details may be sent to the Press Registrar at prrni@nic.in.

3. For any further clarification, etc., on the PRP Act and the Draft PRP Rules, 2024, Shri Amarendra Singh, Deputy Secretary (IP) in the Ministry of I&B may be contacted at amarendra.singh@nic.in.

with regards

Yours sincerely,


(Apurva Chandra)

1. Chief Secretaries of all States
2. Administrators of UTs



भूपेन्द्र कैन्थोला भा सू से
प्रेस महापंजीयक एवं प्रधान महानिदेशक
BHUPENDRA KAINTHOLA IIS
PRESS REGISTRAR GENERAL &
PRINCIPAL DIRECTOR GENERAL



सत्यमेव जयते

भारत सरकार
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
भारत के समाचारपत्रों के पंजीयक का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE REGISTRAR OF NEWSPAPERS FOR INDIA
सूचना एवं प्रसारण मंत्रालय
(MINISTRY OF INFORMATION AND BROADCASTING)
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DO No. IT-AUT-IT-A0MISS/2/2024-IT-AUT

Dated 24th April, 2024

Subject: Implementation of PRP Act 2023 and Training for Specified Authorities

Dear Sir,

I am writing in continuation to Secretary I&B's letter dated 9-1-2024 and my letter dated 31-1-2024 regarding the implementation of the Press and Registration of Periodicals (PRP) Act 2023. The PRP Act and Rules have since been notified by the Government on 1st March 2024. The Act replaces the old PRB Act, 1867 and mandates processing of application for Registration of Newspapers/ Periodicals in the on-line mode through the Press Sewa portal. The portal has already started functioning.

As mentioned earlier, the state/ UT government is required to notify officers as Specified Authorities in the districts as defined under Sec 2(p) of the PRP Act, ("specified authority" means a District Magistrate or Collector or such other officer as the State Government or, as the case may be, Union territory Administration may, by notification, specify). However, we are yet to receive such notification from your state under the Sec 2(p) of the PRP Act. I will once again request you to kindly intervene and send us a copy of the notification in this regard at an early date as the on-boarding and training of Specified Authorities is required so that their input is available as per the mandate of the Act/ Rules and to ensure the effective functioning of the portal and implement various provisions of the Act

In case, there is a possible delay in bringing out such notification about designating specified authorities, I will request you to allow us to onboard the district magistrates/ collectors and go ahead with the training of the officers. The first such virtual training is planned in the first week of May, 2024. This will enable implementation of various provision in the Act as per timelines specified in the PRP Act and Rules.

I will be grateful to you for an early action in the matter.

Sincerely

Bhupendra Kainthola
Press Registrar General of India

To

Chief Secretaries of all States/Administrators of UTs